

Day 47 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Geography of Tamil Nadu's Economic Growth, and Achievements of Tamil Nadu

READING MATERIAL

Covers how Tamil Nadu's geography (ports, industrial corridors, connectivity) supports its economic standing among Indian states, and the state's headline economic achievements. Treat specific growth-rate/ranking figures as snapshots from a particular year, since these are revised annually.

Q: How does Tamil Nadu rank among Indian states by the size of its economy (GSDP), and what is notable about its share of national GDP relative to its land/population share?

A: Tamil Nadu has the 2nd largest state economy in India (after Maharashtra). Notably, with only about 4% of India's land area and roughly 5.46% of its population, Tamil Nadu contributes a disproportionately larger ~8.93% to national GDP (a 2023-24 figure) — reflecting unusually high economic productivity relative to its size.

Q: What port and airport infrastructure does Tamil Nadu have?

A: 3 major ports (Chennai, V.O. Chidambaranar/Tuticorin, and Kamarajar/Ennore), 15 minor ports, and 8 airports — giving the state strong domestic and international connectivity for trade.

Q: What major industrial corridor is being developed in Tamil Nadu, and what is its purpose?

A: The Chennai-Kanyakumari Industrial Corridor (supported by an Asian Development Bank loan) — designed to integrate Tamil Nadu's various regional industrial clusters into a single, connected supply-chain network spanning the state north to south.

Q: What is Tamil Nadu's industrial character, and which sectors does its manufacturing base span?

A: Tamil Nadu is one of India's most industrialised and export-oriented states, with a large, diversified manufacturing base spanning automobiles, electronics, textiles, engineering, pharmaceuticals, and leather.

Q: How does Tamil Nadu rank nationally in terms of Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) inflows?

A: 5th in India in terms of FDI inflows (a specific year's ranking — treat as a snapshot).

Q: What is Tamil Nadu's longer-term economic growth target?

A: The state aims to become a \$1 trillion economy by 2032-33 — part of a broader strategic roadmap toward a much larger (\$4+ trillion, longer-term) economy.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Tamil Nadu has the ____ largest state economy (GSDP) in India.

- A. 1st
- B. 2nd ✓**
- C. 3rd
- D. 5th

Explanation: 2nd largest. [medium, web-research]

2. Tamil Nadu has approximately what share of India's land area, while contributing a much larger share of national GDP?

- A. 1%
- B. 2%
- C. 4% ✓**
- D. 10%

Explanation: About 4% of India's land area. [medium, web-research]

3. How many major ports does Tamil Nadu have?

- A. 1
- B. 2
- C. 3 ✓**
- D. 5

Explanation: 3 major ports. [medium, web-research]

4. The Chennai-Kanyakumari Industrial Corridor is supported by a loan from which institution?

A. World Bank

B. Asian Development Bank ✓

C. International Monetary Fund

D. New Development Bank

Explanation: Asian Development Bank. [medium, web-research]

5. Which of the following is NOT among Tamil Nadu's major manufacturing sectors?

A. Automobiles

B. Textiles

C. Leather

D. Coal mining ✓

Explanation: Coal mining is not a major TN manufacturing sector. [easy, web-research]

6. Tamil Nadu ranks 5th nationally in terms of which economic indicator?

A. Per-capita income

B. FDI inflows ✓

C. Literacy rate

D. Population

Explanation: FDI inflows. [medium, web-research]

7. Tamil Nadu aims to become a \$1 trillion economy by:

A. 2025-26

B. 2028-29

C. 2032-33 ✓

D. 2040-41

Explanation: 2032-33. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Alphanumeric Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Alphanumeric Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, combining letters and numbers in a single pattern. Real exam evidence (independently re-verified) shows three core techniques: letter-to-number position coding, variable-gap letter sequences, and fixed-shift word ciphers.

Q: Method — letter-to-number position coding: If ACEG is coded as 16, and DFGH is coded as 25, how would HIKM be coded?

A: Each letter is converted to its position in the alphabet (A=1, B=2, ... Z=26) and summed. ACEG: A=1, C=3, E=5, G=7, sum=16 ✓. DFGH: D=4, F=6, G=7, H=8, sum=25 ✓. Applying the same rule to HIKM: H=8, I=9, K=11, M=13, sum=8+9+11+13=41.

Q: Method — widening-gap letter sequence: Find the next letter: B, E, I, N, ?

A: Check the gaps between consecutive letters' positions: B(2)→E(5) is +3, E(5)→I(9) is +4, I(9)→N(14) is +5. The gap itself increases by 1 each time, so the next gap is +6: N(14)+6=20, which is T.

Q: Method — fixed-shift word coding (Caesar-cipher style): If ROAD is coded as URDG, how would SWAN be coded using the same rule?

A: Check the shift for each letter: R→U is +3, O→R is +3, A→D is +3, D→G is +3 — a uniform +3 shift applied to every letter. Applying the same +3 shift to SWAN: S→V, W→Z, A→D, N→Q, giving VZDQ.

Q: Method — two-interleaved-sequences letter pair: A pattern alternates first-letters increasing by a fixed gap and second-letters decreasing by the same gap (e.g., AZ, GT, MN, ?, YB). How do you solve it?

A: Track the two positions (first letter, second letter) as SEPARATE sequences. First letters: A(1), G(7), M(13) — increasing by 6 each time, so next is 19=S, then 25=Y (matches the given final term Y). Second letters: Z(26), T(20), N(14) — decreasing by 6 each time, so next is 8=H, then 2=B (matches the given final term B). So the missing term is S+H = 'SH'.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If BDFH is coded as 20 (sum of letter positions), what would CEGI be coded as using the same rule?

- A. 22
- B. 24 ✓**
- C. 26
- D. 28

Explanation: C=3, E=5, G=7, I=9, sum=24. (Check rule: B=2, D=4, F=6, H=8, sum=20 ✓ matches given.) [medium, authored]

2. Find the next letter in the sequence: C, F, J, O, ?

- A. S
- B. T
- C. U ✓**
- D. V

Explanation: Gaps: C(3)→F(6) is +3, F(6)→J(10) is +4, J(10)→O(15) is +5, so next gap is +6: O(15)+6=21=U. [medium, authored]

3. If PLAN is coded as SODQ using a fixed letter shift, how would TRIM be coded using the same rule?

- A. WULP ✓**
- B. WUKP
- C. VULP
- D. WULO

Explanation: Shift check: P→S, L→O, A→D, N→Q — a uniform +3 shift. Applying +3 to TRIM: T→W, R→U, I→L, M→P, giving WULP. [hard, authored]

4. In the sequence DY, IT, NO, ?, XE, the first letters increase and second letters decrease by a fixed gap. What is the missing term?

- A. SJ ✓**
- B. SI
- C. TJ
- D. RJ

Explanation: First letters: D(4), I(9), N(14) — gap +5, so next is 19=S, then 24=X (matches given X). Second letters: Y(25), T(20), O(15) — gap -5, so next is 10=J, then 5=E (matches given E). Missing term: SJ. [hard, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "When the Trees Walked" — Ruskin Bond

READING MATERIAL

A nostalgic story about the narrator's Grandfather, a retired Indian Forest Service officer settled in the fertile Doon Valley, whose deep love for trees and planting is illustrated through a curious vine tendril, several fruit trees, and his decision to spare a peepul tree growing through an old outhouse wall.

Q: Who is sitting with the narrator on the veranda steps, and what is his professional background?

A: The narrator's Grandfather, a retired officer of the Indian Forest Service, who built his bungalow on the outskirts of Dehradun (Doon Valley) after retirement.

Q: What curious thing does the narrator notice near the steps, and how long does it take to reach Grandfather's feet?

A: A tendril of a vine, slowly growing toward Grandfather — it takes about 20 minutes to reach his feet.

Q: What explanation does the narrator suggest for the tendril's movement toward Grandfather, and what reason does the narrator prefer to believe instead?

A: The suggested scientific explanation is that the vine is moving toward light and warmth. But the narrator prefers to believe (more fancifully) that the tendril simply wanted to be near Grandfather.

Q: What kind of climate does the Doon Valley have, and which fruit trees did Grandfather plant there?

A: A fertile climate. Grandfather planted Lime, Mango, Orange, and Guava trees.

Q: What tree grew through the wall of an abandoned outhouse, and why was it not cut down?

A: A Peepul tree grew through the wall. It was not cut down because Grandfather liked it.

Q: What did Grandfather say instead of ordering the peepul tree to be cut down?

A: "Let it grow, we'll build another outhouse" — choosing to accommodate the tree rather than remove it, reflecting his deep respect for trees and nature.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "When the Trees Walked" was written by:

A. Ruskin Bond ✓

B. R.K. Narayan

C. Munshi Premchand

D. James Thurber

Explanation: Ruskin Bond. [easy, web-research]

2. Who is sitting with the narrator on the veranda steps?

A. Grandmother

B. Friend

C. Grandfather ✓

D. Teacher

Explanation: Grandfather. [easy, web-research]

3. What did the narrator notice slowly moving near the steps?

A. A dog

B. A butterfly

C. A tendril of a vine ✓

D. A flower pot

Explanation: A tendril of a vine. [medium, web-research]

4. How long did it take the tendril to reach Grandfather's feet?

A. 10 minutes

B. 1 hour

C. 20 minutes ✓

D. 5 minutes

Explanation: 20 minutes. [medium, web-research]

5. What reason does the narrator prefer to believe for the tendril's movement?

- A. It wanted sunlight
- B. It wanted water
- C. It was escaping insects

D. It wanted to be near Grandfather ✓

Explanation: It wanted to be near Grandfather. [medium, web-research]

6. Where did Grandfather build his bungalow after retirement?

- A. Delhi
- B. Mumbai
- C. Ooty

D. Doon Valley ✓

Explanation: Doon Valley. [medium, web-research]

7. Grandfather had served in which profession before retirement?

- A. Postal service
- B. Indian Forest Service ✓**
- C. Medicine
- D. Teaching

Explanation: Indian Forest Service. [medium, web-research]

8. Which fruit trees did Grandfather plant?

- A. Neem and Banyan
- B. Lime, Mango, Orange, Guava ✓**
- C. Rose and Lily
- D. Palm and Cedar

Explanation: Lime, Mango, Orange, Guava. [medium, web-research]

9. What tree grew through the wall of an abandoned outhouse?

- A. Banyan
- B. Mango
- C. Peepul ✓**
- D. Neem

Explanation: Peepul. [medium, web-research]

10. What did Grandfather say instead of cutting down the peepul tree?

- A. "Let's burn it"
- B. "Let it grow, we'll build another outhouse" ✓**
- C. "Let's decorate it"
- D. "We can shift it"

Explanation: "Let it grow, we'll build another outhouse." [hard, web-research]